MIL-C-80090C
17 June 1985
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-80090B
30 August 1974

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CUTTING SYSTEM, METAL, PLASMA ARC

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers cutting systems which utilize a plasma arc as the cutting medium and are furnished with the equipment and accessories specified herein.

1.2 Classification. This specification covers cutting systems of the following sizes. The size to be furnished shall be as specified (see 6.2.1 and table I).

Size 1 -	30 Amperes DC,	20 percent duty cycle.
Size 2 -	50 Amperes DC,	60 percent duty cycle.
Size 3 -	120 Amperes DC,	100 percent duty cycle.
Size 4 -	250 Amperes DC,	100 percent duty cycle.
Size 5 -	400 Amperes DC,	100 percent duty cycle.
Size 6 -	500 Amperes DC,	100 percent duty cycle.
Size 7 -	1,000 Amperes DC,	100 percent duty cycle.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Industrial Plant Equipment Center, ATTN: DIPEC-SSG, Memphis, Tennessee 38114-5297, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 3433

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2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. Unless otherwise specified, the following specifications, standards, and handbooks of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-E-17555 - Electronic and Electrical Equipment, Accessories, Repair Parts, Packaging and Packing of.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-H28 - Screw Thread Standards for Federal Services.

FED-STD-376 - Preferred Metric Units for General Use by the Federal Government.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-461 - Electromagnetic Emission and Susceptibility Requirements for the Control of Electromagnetic Interference.

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

U. S. DEPARTMENT OF LABOR

OSHA 2206 - General Industry, OSHA Safety and Health Standards (29 CFR 1910).

(Copies of specifications, standards, handbooks, drawings, and publications required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document(s) form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. The issues of the documents which are indicated as DoD adopted shall be the issue listed in the current DoDISS and the supplement thereto, if applicable.

AMERICAN NATIONAL STANDARDS INSTITUTE (ANSI)

ANSI/NFPA 70 - National Electrical Code.

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(Application for copies should be addressed to the American National Standards Institute, ATTN: Sales Dept., 1430 Broadway, New York, NY 10018.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race St., Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First Article. When specified (see 6.2.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3 and 6.3).

3.2 Design. The cutting system shall be new and one of the manufacturer's current models capable of cutting metals in accordance with the requirements herein. The system shall include all components, parts, and features necessary to meet the performance requirements specified herein. All parts subject to wear, breakage, or distortion shall be accessible for adjustment, replacement, and repair.

3.2.1 Measurement systems. Unless otherwise specified, either the U.S. Customary System of Units (US) or the International System of Units (SI) shall be used in the design and construction of the system. When only one system of measurements is acceptable, the particular system required shall be as specified (see 6.2.1). In this specification, all measurements, dimensions, sizes, and capacities are given in US units. These measurements may be converted to SI units through the use of the conversion factors and methods specified in FED-STD-376.

3.2.1.1 Measuring and indicating device calibrations. Unless otherwise specified, either the U.S. Customary System of Units (US) or the International System of Units (SI) shall be used to graduate measuring and indicating devices such as scales, depth stops, carriage stops, dial indicators, pressure gauges, temperature indicators, and other similar devices. When only one system of graduation is acceptable, the particular graduation required shall be as specified (see 6.2.1). Regardless of the measurement system used, all measuring and indicating devices on the system shall be graduated in the same system.

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3.2.2 Reclaimed materials. The system may contain reclaimed materials provided such materials will not jeopardize the system's intended use and performance. The reclaimed materials shall have been reprocessed, remanufactured, or recycled in a manner which will restore them to the same chemical composition and physical properties as the materials originally selected for use on the system.

3.2.3 Energy efficiency. The cutting system and its applicable components that directly consume energy in normal operation shall be designed and constructed for the highest degree of energy efficiency as governed by the latest developments available within the Industry.

3.2.4 Safety and health requirements. All safety devices normally incorporated in this equipment by the manufacturer for the protection of the operator shall be furnished. The outer shell of the plasma torch assembly shall be electrically insulated to insure that the operator will not be exposed to electrically charged components. A safety device shall be provided to disconnect cutting power from the torch in the event the cooling medium or plasma gas falls below a safe operating level. All system parts, components, mechanisms, and assemblies furnished on the system, whether or not specifically required herein, shall comply with all of the requirements of OSHA 2206 that are applicable to the system itself. Additional safety and health requirements shall be as specified (see 6.2.1).

3.2.5 Mercury restriction. The system shall not contain mercury or mercury compounds nor be exposed to free mercury during manufacture.

3.2.6 Asbestos restriction. Asbestos and materials containing asbestos shall not be used on or in the system.

3.2.7 Environmental protection. The system shall be so designed and constructed that, under the operating, service, transportation, and storage conditions described herein, the system shall not emit materials hazardous to the ecological system as prescribed by federal, state, or local statutes in effect at point of installation (see 6.4).

3.2.8 Interchangeability. All parts shall be manufactured to definite dimensions and tolerances that will permit installation of replacement parts without modification of the part or system.

3.3 Construction. The cutting system shall be constructed of parts which are new, without defects, and free of repairs. The structure shall be capable of withstanding all forces encountered during operation of the system at its maximum rating and capacity without permanent distortion.

3.3.1 Castings and forgings. All castings and forgings shall be free from defects such as scale and mismatching. Processes such as welding, peening, plugging, or filling with solders or pastes shall not be used on castings or forgings to reclaim any defective components for use on the

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system. Such processes may be used only for enhancing surface finish and appearance.

3.3.2 Welding, brazing, or soldering. Welding, brazing, or soldering shall be employed only where specified in the original design. None of these processes shall be employed as a repair measure for any defective part.

3.3.3 Fastening devices. All screws, pins, bolts, and other fasteners shall be installed in a manner to prevent change of tightness. Fastening devices subject to removal or adjustment shall not be swaged, peened, staked, or otherwise permanently installed.

3.3.4 Surfaces. All surfaces shall be clean and free of sand, dirt, fins, sprues, flash, scale, flux, and other harmful or extraneous materials. All edges shall be either rounded or beveled unless sharpness is required to perform a necessary function. Except as otherwise specified herein, the condition and finish of all surfaces shall be in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice.

3.3.5 Painting. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), the cutting system shall be painted in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice, provided that all surfaces to be painted shall be cleaned of all foreign matter and at least one coat of primer and one coat of finish color is applied. A coat of paint with a built in primer is acceptable.

3.3.6 Threads. All threaded parts used on the cutting system and its related attachments and accessories shall conform to FED-STD-H28.

3.3.7 Electromagnetic interference control. When specified (see 6.2.1), equipment procured under this specification shall comply with the requirements of MIL-STD-461. The equipment and subsystem class and the emission and susceptibility requirements shall be as specified.

3.4 Components.

3.4.1 Power supply (DC). The power supply shall be of the transformer-rectifier type, designed for plasma arc cutting purposes. The rated DC output current and duty cycle shall be not less than stated in paragraph 1.2 for the size specified. The size 1, size 2, and size 3 systems may be furnished with or without provisions for varying the output current. The size 4 thru size 7 systems shall have provisions for controlling the output current. A front panel mounted ammeter for measuring the DC current shall be furnished with all systems having provision for varying the output current. The open circuit output voltage shall be not less than 200 volts. The power supply shall be enclosed in a cabinet of steel frame construction. The cabinet panels shall be constructed of steel, aluminum, or plastic. The thickness of the materials used in construction and the physical strength of the chassis and cabinet shall be adequate for support and protection of all components. The sides and top panels of the cabinet shall be removable to pro-

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vide access for servicing. Openings shall be provided for adequate ventilation. Forced air cooling shall be provided by a fan mounted inside the cabinet. The power supply shall be capable of operating under full load in an ambient temperature of 115 degrees Fahrenheit. A suitably rated contactor shall be furnished for use in the primary input power circuit. When two or more power supplies are furnished for parallel operation, all necessary connecting cables and hardware shall be furnished.

3.4.2 Torches. The torches, when furnished, shall be gas or water cooled. Replacement, positioning, and adjustment of the electrode, nozzle, and associated parts shall be accomplished without the use of special tools, except as supplied with the system. Cooling gas or water shall be supplied through the electric power cables.

3.4.2.1 Mechanized torch. When specified (see 6.2.1), a torch designed for mechanized cutting and for mounting on a carriage mechanism capable of plasma arc cutting speeds shall be furnished. The torch shall be designed for operation with the DC power supply specified in 3.4.1. The type and quantity of nozzles to be furnished shall be as specified (see 6.2.1).

3.4.2.2 Manual torch. When specified (see 6.2.1), a manual type (hand held) torch shall be furnished. The torch shall be designed for operation with the DC power supply specified in 3.4.1. A switch shall be located on the handle to control operation of the cutting system. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), the torch shall have a 70 or 75 degree head angle. The type and quantity of nozzles to be furnished shall be as specified (see 6.2.1).

3.4.3 Power cables and hose assemblies. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), the DC power cables supplying power to the torch shall be gas or water cooled. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), all power cables and hoses between the control console or power supply and torch shall be not less than 25 feet length. All electrical power cables, gas, and or water supply hoses, connectors, and fitting necessary for operation of the cutting system at full rated power shall be furnished.

3.4.4 Controls and control console. All controls, gauges, and indicating lights necessary for complete operation of the cutting system shall be mounted in a control console or on the DC power supply. On size 6 and size 7 systems a control console shall be furnished. The control console shall be located at a point convenient to the operator. The control console may be utilized as the operator's panel, or a separate operator's panel may be furnished.

3.4.5 Water cooling system. When a water cooling system is furnished it shall be equipped with an electric motor driven water pump. The pump shall be capable of pumping the quantity of water from the plant water supply required to provide cooling for 100% duty cycle operation of the torch at full rated power. When specified (see 6.2.1), a recirculating type cool-

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ing system, with the capability to provide cooling for 100% duty cycle operation of the torch at full rated power shall be supplied.

3.4.6 Electrical system. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), the electrical system shall conform to ANSI/NFPA 70. The size 1 cutting system shall operate from a 220 volt, 1 phase, 60 Hz circuit. The size 2 thru size 7 cutting system shall operate from a 230/460 volt, 3 phase, 60 Hz circuit. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), the size 2 thru size 7 system shall be initially wired for operation on 460 volts.

3.4.6.1 Motors. Motors shall be rated for continuous duty and shall have ball or roller bearings of the sealed and permanently lubricated type. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), each motor enclosure shall meet the requirements for a dripproof enclosure.

3.4.6.2. Solid state components. Solid state design shall be used throughout for electronic components.

3.4.6.3 Control circuit voltage. Auxiliary control circuits shall be isolated from the input electric power supply by a low-voltage transformer having a secondary voltage no greater than 115 volts.

3.5 Performance. The cutting systems shall meet all requirements specified herein. Cutting speeds of the system shall be not less than specified in table I.

TABLE I. Cutting speed (inches per minute).

Size	Material: Low carbon steel (1020 - 1030) (thickness in inches)						Material: Aluminum (thickness in inches)					
	1/8	1/4	1/2	1	2	3	1/8	1/4	1/2	1	2	3
1	35	--	--	--	--	--	50	--	--	--	--	--
2	90	35	--	--	--	--	90	35	--	--	--	--
3	--	--	25	12	--	--	--	--	50	8	--	--
4	--	--	40	28	--	--	--	--	100	50	--	--
5	--	--	--	42	20	--	--	--	--	80	40	--
6	--	--	--	50	20	--	--	--	--	80	35	--
7	--	--	--	--	25	10	--	--	--	--	35	18

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3.5.1 Additional performance requirements. Performance features required in addition to, or in lieu of, the requirements herein shall be as specified and fully described (see 6.2.1).

3.6 Standard equipment. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), the system shall be furnished with all standard equipment normally furnished by the manufacturer.

3.7 Optional equipment. Optional equipment shall be furnished as specified and shall be fully described (see 6.2.1).

3.8 Repair parts. Such repair parts as are specified (see 6.2.1), shall be furnished.

3.9 Marking of plates and charts. All words on plates and charts shall be in the English language. Characters shall be engraved, etched, embossed or stamped in boldface on a contrasting background. When these methods are not practicable, the instructions shall be applied directly on the item by environmentally protected decalcomania transfer, metal wrap-around tag, stencil, silk screen or by any other method suitable for the use intended which shall be as permanent as the normal life expectancy of the item to which it is applied and capable of withstanding the environmental tests and cleaning procedures specified for the item.

3.9.1 Nameplate. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), a nameplate shall be securely attached to each cutting system. The nameplate shall contain the information listed below. If the cutting system is a special model, the model designation shall include the model of the basic standard system and a suffix identified in the manufacturer's permanent records. The captions listed may be shortened or abbreviated, provided the entry for each caption is clear as to its identity.

Nomenclature
Manufacturer's name
Manufacturer's model designation
Manufacturer's serial number
Power input (volts, total amps, phase, frequency)
Contract Number or Order Number
National Stock Number or Plant Equipment Code
Date of manufacture

3.10 Hour meter. When specified (see 6.2.1), the system shall be equipped with an hour meter. The hour meter shall be installed to display accumulated operating time of the power supply. The meter shall be of the non-resetting type and shall have a range of 0 to 99,999 hours in increments of one hour. The meter shall be sealed to prevent the entrance of dust and moisture and shall be mounted to withstand shock and vibration generated by

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the system. Upon reaching the maximum cumulative hours, the meter readout shall automatically revert to zero and continue to totalize time.

3.11 Technical data. When technical data is required it shall be furnished in accordance with the requirements of the contract. All technical data furnished shall be written in the English language.

3.12 Workmanship. Workmanship of the cutting system and accessories shall be of a quality equal to that of the manufacturer's commercial equipment of the type specified herein.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility of inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).

b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article inspection is required, it shall be applied to the first article submitted in accordance with 3.1. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2.1), first article inspection shall consist of the examination in 4.5 and all tests in 4.6. Failure of the item to pass the first article examination and all tests shall be cause for rejection.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Quality conformance inspection shall be applied to each item prior to being offered for acceptance under the contract. Unless other wise specified (see 6.2.1), quality conformance inspection shall consist of the examination in 4.5, the test in 4.6.1, and the inspection in 4.7. Failure of the item to pass the examination, test, and inspection shall be cause for rejection.

4.5 Examination. The machine and equipment shall be visually examined to determine compliance with all requirements of this specification.

4.6 Tests.

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4.6.1 Operational test. The cutting system shall be connected to the specified input power, primary gas, and cooling medium. All components of the system shall be operated as required to assure proper functioning of all sub-assemblies and controls. The starting arc shall be tested for proper operation. The torch shall be tested for proper transfer of the power arc and gases from the torch to the workpiece. All meters, gauges, and pilot lights shall be observed for proper operation. When applicable, the water circulating system shall be checked to assure proper operation.

4.6.2 Performance test. The complete system utilizing a cutting gas and a torch selected by the manufacturer shall be tested to determine conformance with 3.5. This shall be accomplished by cutting a 48 inch long piece of low carbon steel of the thickness specified in table I for the size cutting system being tested. The cutting speed of the system shall meet or exceed the cutting requirements of table I.

4.6.3 Electromagnetic interference control tests. Equipment requiring electromagnetic interference control shall be tested for compliance with 3.3.7.

4.7 Packaging inspection. Packaging of each item shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements of Section 5.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging, packing, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, packaging, packing, and marking shall be in accordance with ASTM D 3951. When specified (see 6.2.1), level A or level B preservation, level A or level B packing and special marking shall be accomplished in accordance with MIL-E-17555.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The plasma arc cutting system described in this specification will be used for cutting metal, using a hand held torch or a machine mounted torch.

6.2 Ordering data.

6.2.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.

b. Size required (see 1.2).

c. When first article is required for inspection and approval (see 3.1).

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d. If system is required to be configured in a specific measurement system (US or SI), state required system (see 3.2.1).

e. If measuring and indicating devices are required to be graduated in a specific measurement system (US or SI), state required system (see 3.2.1.1).

f. Additional safety and health requirements, if required (see 3.2.4).

g. Painting, if different (see 3.3.5).

h. If electromagnetic interference control is required, specify the equipment and subsystem class and the emission and susceptibility required (see 3.3.7).

i. Mechanized torch, if required specify type and quantity of nozzles required and type and thickness of material to be cut, (see 3.4.2.1).

j. Manual torch, if required specify type and quantity of nozzles required and type and thickness of material to be cut (see 3.4.2.2).

k. Angle of torch head, if different (see 3.4.2.2).

l. DC power cable cooling system if different, specify type of cooling required (see 3.4.3).

m. Length of power cables and hose assemblies, if different (see 3.4.3).

n. Type of water cooling system, if required (see 3.4.5).

o. Electrical system and input power requirements if different (see 3.4.6).

p. Motor enclosure, if different (see 3.4.6.1).

q. Additional performance requirements, if required (see 3.5.1).

r. Standard equipment, if different (see 3.6).

s. Specify and fully describe optional equipment required (see 3.7).

t. Specify applicable repair parts, if required (see 3.8).

u. Nameplate, if different (see 3.9.1).

v. Hour meter, if required (see 3.10).

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w. First article inspection, if different (see 4.3).

x. Quality conformance inspection, if different (see 4.4).

y. If packaging, packing, and marking in accordance with MIL-E-17555 is required, specify level required, and specification number (see 5.1).

6.2.2 Contract data requirements. Required technical data such as operators manuals, parts lists, wiring diagrams, and examination, original alignment and tolerance test reports, and other instruction for operation and maintenance (as identified on a DD Form 1664, Data Item Description) should be specified on a DD Form 1423, Contract Data Requirements List incorporated into the contract.

6.3 First article. When first article inspection is required, the item to be tested should be the first item offered for acceptance under the contract. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examination, test, and approval of the first article.

6.4 Safety and health requirements. Paragraph 3.2.4 requires compliance only with those OSHA requirements that concern the system itself. It does not require compliance with those OSHA requirements that concern "the system in its operating environment: such as noise levels, radiation levels, electromagnetic emissions, noxious vapors, air contaminants, and heat. Since OSHA limits the total hazard level of these hazards in the environment (and does not limit the hazard level of individual systems in the environment) the procuring activity is advised to analyze the existing hazard levels in the proposed operating environment, and specify additional system requirements that will integrate the new system into its future operating environment. The system shall be equipped with all point-of-operation guarding normally furnished as standard on the manufacturer's commercial systems supplied to the commercial market. If specific point-of-operation guarding is required, the procuring activity should specify the exact configuration of the guard required, as in most cases, the guard configuration is dependent on the size and configuration of the workpieces. The above, and any other additional safety and health requirement should be specified in detail under 6.2.1 (f).

6.5 Cross-reference of classification changes. System classification changes from the previous issue of this specification are as follows:

MIL-C-80090	MIL-C-80090A	MIL-C-80090B	MIL-C-80090C
Type I (new type)	Type I (no change)	Type I (deleted)	Size 1 (new size)
Type II (new type)	Type II (no change)	Type II (deleted)	Size 2 (new size)
			Size 3 (new size)
			Size 4 (new size)
			Size 5 (new size)
			Size 6 (new size)
			Size 7 (new size)

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Army - AL
Navy - SH
Air Force - 99

Review Activity:
DLA - GS
Air Force - 84
Navy - MC

User Activities:
Army - AV, AR

Preparing Activity:
DLA - IP

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NOTE: **This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.**

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(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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